

Wonder Gardens

Audience and Genre Overview

Wonder Gardens is an interactive experience where a group of people pick flowers in order to craft bouquets as gifts for each other. The audience, which is meant to be children around age 10-15, will learn about the language of flowers and determine which flowers would be best suited for someone based on two things: a flower's meanings or symbolisms, and participant's personality type. The initial premise of the experience is the process of gift-giving and the navigation of figuring out what would make a good gift for someone, which is why this experience is directed at Socializer-type players.

The genre of *Wonder Gardens* is Life, as it is about normal people going through their lives and focuses on a particular aspect of everyday life. The experience takes place in a relaxed atmosphere (a flower garden) and its main plot focuses on a low-stakes, mundane problem: "What do I get for this person?" The characters in the experience are the owners of the garden, Otto and Gerbera, who serve as a herald and a mentor, and the participants, who all play an innocent child role.

Five Es of Immersive Storytelling

Enticing: The participants will hear about this experience through online advertisements or local flyers. After signing up to take part, they will be given a link to an online personality test that must be taken prior to the experience.

Entering: The location involves having several acres of botanical gardens and natural forests and a building that is styled to look like a Victorian-era house; the experience itself would be housed in the house's backyard garden. The purpose of the outdoor gardens is to begin to pull the participants into the experience and force out most modern-day interruptions like city noise pollution.

Engaging: The participants have two rooms to explore: the library and the garden. They will each be given a card with a personality type on it; this is the personality type of another participant who will remain anonymous. From there, the participants will follow a set of clues that will provide insight into the kinds of flowers that would make sense for their designated recipient, as they will need to learn about the language of flowers. By learning about flower meanings, the participants will need to connect flower meanings with their recipient's personality type.

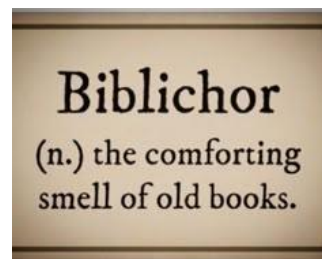
Exiting: Once the participants have made their bouquet, they'll turn it in to Gerbera, the botanist. She will hand out bouquets to their designated recipients and explain what each of the flowers mean and how they would be associated with the recipient's personality.

Extending: The idea is that the bouquet will serve as both a nice decoration and as a meaningful gift from someone. Looking at it should remind the recipient about what the flowers mean and how they apply to them personally, as well as the effort that they themselves put into making a bouquet for someone else.

Characters

The participants all assume the role of being player characters, which is meant to be an innocent child archetype. Everyone has the same goal in mind: make a flower bouquet for their anonymous recipient. To make the best and most meaningful bouquet, they'll need to learn about their recipient and the language of flowers. Every participant's character arc is about learning about other people and how to make a special gift for someone.

A character who will not be present in the experience is Otto. Otto is a historian who is very busy with his work, as he is often dealing with the preservation and presentation of old texts. In the experience, he is working away from home, so the participants may only know him through the things he's left around in his library.



The character who will be present in the experience is Gerbera. Gerbera is a botanist and has turned her yard into quite the floral spectacle. She is a resource on everything about flowers and her garden, so the participants can ask her for advice as they hunt for flowers.



Character Table

Character	Archetype	Relation to PC	Age	Interests	Dreams/Goals
Otto	Herald	Indirect guide (through notes left in library)	50	History	To preserve history and establish a grand library
Gerbera	Mentor	Experience guide	50	Botany	To study plants to determine useful applications in other fields
Participants	Innocent	Anonymous to each other	10-15	Depends on personality test results	Depends on personality test results

Aspects of Interactive Storytelling

Uncover player backstory and motivations

All participants are required to complete a personality test prior to the flower-picking part of the experience. They are asked questions about what things they prefer or what they would do in hypothetical situations, and from there they are assigned a personality type. The participants do not know their own personality type until the end of the experience when they are presented with their gifted bouquets. Through the meanings of the flowers in their bouquet they will learn about themselves.

Exploring player agency and impact

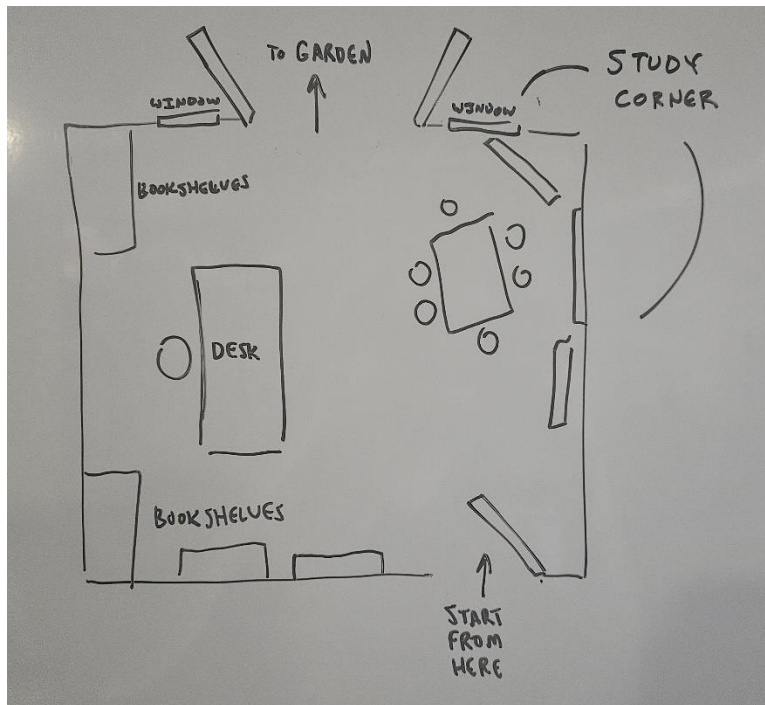
This experience is supposed to guide the group through the flower-picking process, but the participants themselves are the ones who are making the decisions about which flowers will work best. The group determines how a session goes; the personality test sets another participant's goal and how well the participants put together bouquets will determine the level of success at the end (which is subjectively based on recipient feedback/feelings).

Designing a system with high re-playability

A feature of the experience is its group-based play. The same group of people could play it a few times and be matched up differently each time, thus yielding potential for unique bouquets with each session. The members of a group could have some of its members switched out each time. Since the experience's goal is dependent on the people in it, changing the configuration of people should make for a different experience. Or, if someone were to experience it once, then come back after some years to experience it again, they may get a different personality type due to changes they have gone through in their life in that time.

Locations

Library



An in-house library, this is the only part of Otto and Gerbera's house that will be accessible and will be the starting area of the experience. The overall vibe the room should give off is like being in a professor's study or office and will have a pleasant musty smell in the air. The lighting will be from chandeliers and candles; there should be very little natural light, only whatever can make it through thick window curtains. The library is accessed through a door that leads directly to the garden. This room is associated with Otto, as he is a historian and reads lots of books and other written documents.

The study corner resembles what you might find in a college library. The Archetype Diagrams are hung up on movable chalkboards, and the table has notebooks and Flower Dictionaries ready to be used by participants.

Items here include:

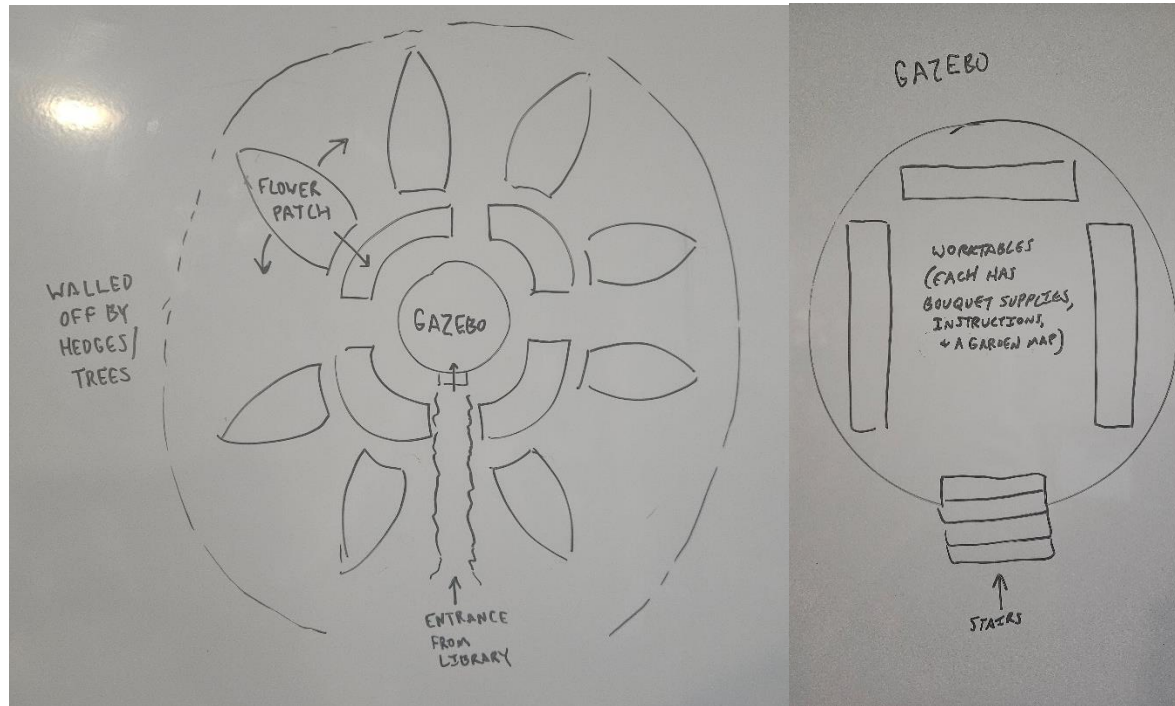
Notecard: given out as participants walk in. Only has a silhouette of a person on it.

Flower Dictionaries: a field guide on flowers.

Archetypal Diagrams: reports of commonly occurring archetypes in global cultures.

Notebooks and pens: empty pocket-sized books to take notes.

Garden



The garden will be walled off by tall hedges that enclose several large flower patches. In the center of the flower patches is a gazebo that serves as a workstation to make bouquets. The space should have a warm and refreshing vibe to it and will smell of flowers and petrichor. The garden should be beautiful to look at, even when the weather is cloudy or rainy. The garden is associated with Gerbera since she is a botanist and knows how to best care for plants.

Items here include:

Flowers: several species of flowers are grown in the garden, waiting to be picked for a bouquet.

Garden Map: a graphic showing where each flower species is grown in the garden.

Bouquet Supplies: resources for preparing a bouquet. Includes wrap, ribbon, and notecards.

Bouquet Instructions: a graphic showing how to make a bouquet.

Orders of Discovery

Ideally, the participant will want to explore the library first, as it is the first space they will be in. They should then examine the Archetype Diagrams and gather the necessary information from them before moving onto the Flower Dictionary to determine which flowers they need. Then, they'll go out into the garden and find the flowers on their list. Using the Garden Map is optional; the participant may use it if they feel they are having trouble looking for a particular flower. Then, once all flowers have been amassed, the participant can then use the Bouquet Supplies to put their picked flowers into a bouquet.

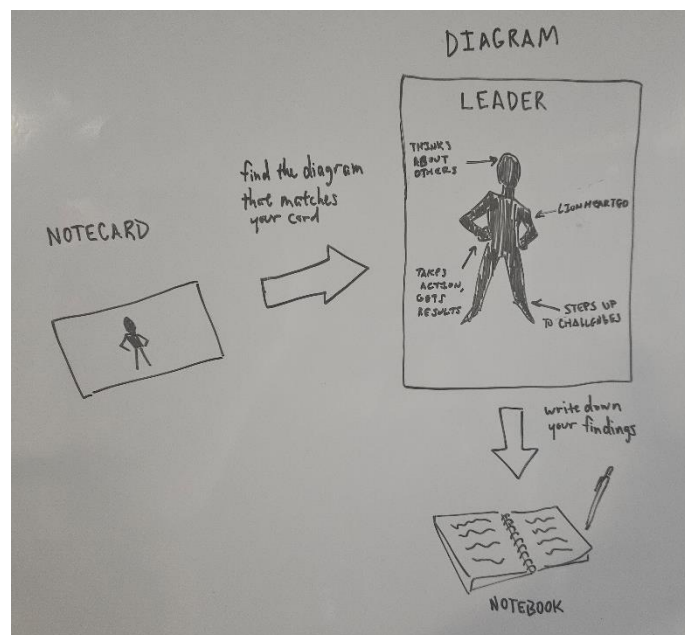
Other orders of discovery will likely cause confusion in the participant. Even though the starting room is the library, the participant could choose to go straight to the garden without checking the Archetype Diagrams or the Flower Dictionary first. If they aren't familiar with flower symbolism, they will likely pick flowers that do not match their recipient's archetype.

Puzzles

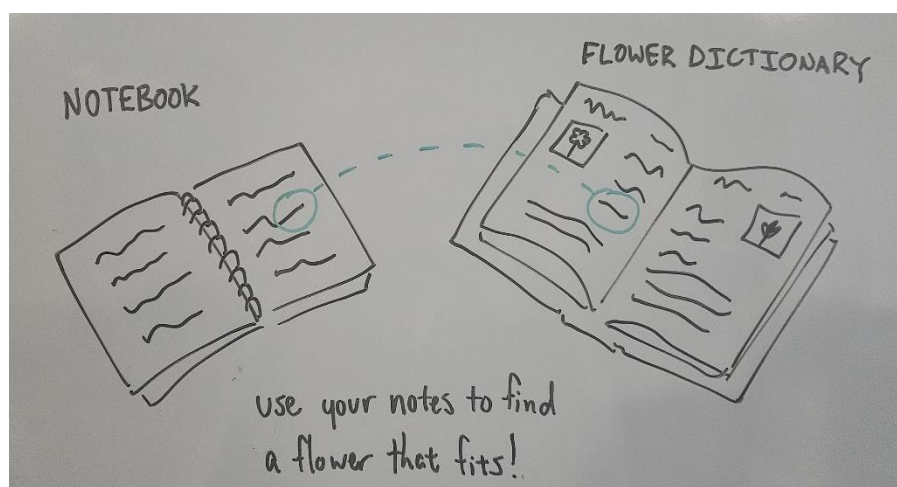
Meta-puzzle: determining the best bouquet

This is the overarching puzzle of the experience, which is made up of multiple parts. The "solution" is a bouquet that has flowers with meanings in it that closely match the attributes of its recipient's archetype. In order to do so, the following must be achieved:

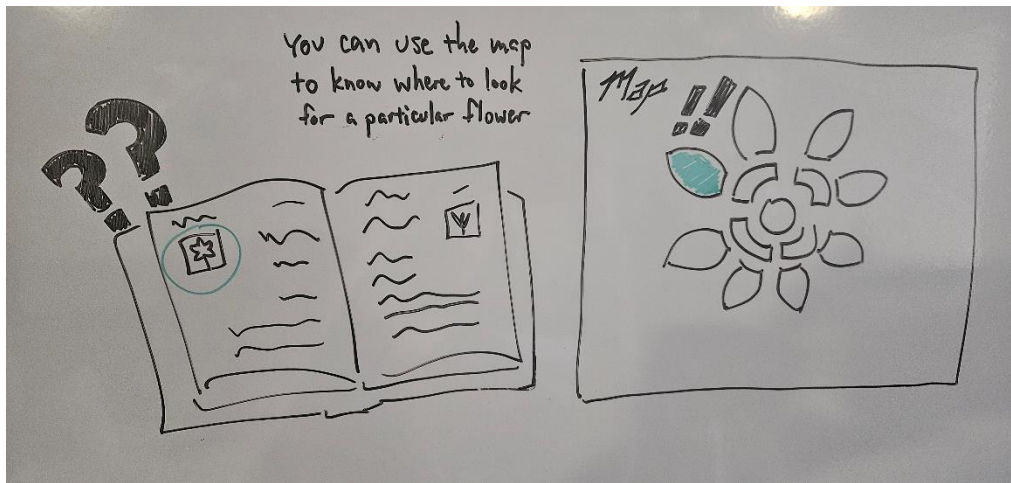
- Once given an archetype to design their bouquet for, the participant needs to learn what that archetype is like. They will do so by finding the correct Archetype Diagram in the library and will find three things that describe the archetype.



- Using the archetype descriptors, the participant can now look for flowers that would suit that archetype. They will need to read through the flower dictionary to find flowers that symbolize the archetype descriptors and make a list of flowers to search for.



- With their list made, the participant can explore the garden with their list of flowers in mind. They can choose to wander or refer to the garden map to look for the flowers they want to pick.



Media

Media that can be found in the library includes:

Notecard: given to all participants. There are six different cards, each one with a silhouette that indicates which archetype the participant needs to find.

Flower Dictionaries: multiple copies of a book on flowers. Contains general information about the flowers being grown in the garden, as well as additional notes that Gerbera and Otto have added.

Archetypal Diagrams: Otto's research into world literature has led him to making reports about different character archetypes he has come across in global cultures. Each diagram has a picture depicting the archetype, with details about the common attributes expressed by the archetype.

Media that can be found in the garden includes:

Garden Map: a graphic showing where each flower species is grown in the garden. Shows a bird's-eye view of the garden, with labels on each flower patch/section.

Bouquet Instructions: a set of instructions graphically depicting a basic method for putting together a bouquet.

Links

[Sherlock_FlowerDictionarySample](#)

[Sherlock_WonderGardensTrailerScript](#)